Introduction

This page describes the **modeling guidelines for initiatives** in the context of enterprise architecture at Porsche. It is based on the general modeling guidelines of PAG and includes specific instructions for creating and maintaining initiative fact sheets in LeanIX. The creation and editing of an initiative fact sheet follows the standard procedure for creating a general fact sheet as described in "How to create a fact sheet".

General Modeling Rules

Subscriptions

In LeanIX, **subscriptions** are used to assign individuals and roles to a Fact Sheet. There are two main types of subscriptions:

- **Responsible**: Individuals accountable for the content and maintenance of the Fact Sheet.
- **Observer**: Individuals who are informed but not responsible for the content.

The specific roles that can be assigned to a Fact Sheet are defined in the modeling guidelines for each Fact Sheet type.

Responsibility Requirement

Each Fact Sheet must have **at least one person assigned as Responsible**. This person (or persons):

- Is accountable for the **accuracy, completeness, and currency** of the Fact Sheet.
- Receives **notifications** about changes to the Fact Sheet.
- Acts as the **primary contact** for questions, clarifications, or requirements related to the Fact Sheet.

Change of Responsibility

If a Responsible person:

- Changes roles,
- Leaves the company or department,
- Or is no longer involved with the Fact Sheet,

…it is their duty to ensure a **successor** is assigned to maintain the Fact Sheet.

Automated Quality Checks

LeanIX includes automated processes to ensure data quality. These processes include:

1. **Inactive Responsible Person**
   If a Responsible person is no longer active in the company or subsidiary (e.g., due to departure), the system checks for other Responsible persons:
   - If none exist, the **direct manager** of the former Responsible is identified and automatically assigned as the new Responsible.
   - The manager also receives a **To-Do** to assign a new, appropriate Responsible person.
   - This escalation continues up to the **department head level** if necessary.
2. **No Responsible Assigned**
   If no Responsible is assigned to a Fact Sheet:
   - The system uses the **"Responsible IT Department"** relation to identify the appropriate manager.
   - This manager is then assigned as the Responsible person and is expected to **nominate a qualified business owner**.

Lifecycle Management in LeanIX Fact Sheets

Each **Fact Sheet type** in LeanIX can be assigned a **lifecycle**. Whether this assignment is **mandatory** depends on the specific Fact Sheet type and is indicated on its detail page.

Recommended Practice

Regardless of whether the lifecycle is mandatory, it is **strongly recommended** to provide the following information:

- **Start of productive use** (Go-Live date)
- **Decommissioning date** (if known)

Depending on the desired level of detail, additional lifecycle milestones can also be modeled (e.g., development start, pilot phase, sunset planning).

Benefits

Accurate lifecycle data supports:

- **Strategic planning** and **portfolio management**
- **Compliance** with regulatory and audit requirements

- **Impact analysis** for changes and decommissioning
- **Architecture governance** across all layers

Organizational Responsibilities

Each Fact Sheet in LeanIX must include an assignment of **organizational responsibility**. This responsibility can be defined at two levels:

- **Organizational Structure Level** (e.g., departments, business units)
- **Process Organization Level** (e.g., Agile Release Trains, portfolios)

For certain Fact Sheet types, a distinction may also be made between **functional (business) responsibility** and **technical (IT) responsibility**.

> At least one form of responsibility must be specified—either at the organizational structure level or the process organization level.
> Ideally, both levels should be documented to ensure full traceability and accountability.
>
> **If IT responsibility is defined as mandatory in the modeling guidelines for a specific Fact Sheet type, it must be provided without exception.**

Responsibility at the Organizational Structure Level

At Porsche, the **organizational structure** is defined by the official organizational chart, which organizes the company into hierarchical levels such as:

- Division
- Main Department
- Department
- Subdepartment (lowest level)

> In LeanIX modeling, unless explicitly stated otherwise, responsibility must always be assigned to the **lowest available level** of the organizational structure.

Key Principles

- Always reference the **most granular organizational unit** available.
- Ensure that the assigned unit reflects the **actual operational responsibility**.
- This ensures **clear accountability**, **accurate reporting**, and **effective governance**.

Responsibility at the Process Organization Level

Many IT products and applications at Porsche are developed and operated by **Agile Release Trains (ARTs)**. Others are managed within specific **portfolios**.

Assignment Guidelines

- If an **ART** is responsible for a product (or any other relevant Fact Sheet type), this responsibility must be **explicitly documented** in LeanIX by assigning the corresponding ART Fact Sheet.
- If the responsibility lies with a **single portfolio**—as is often the case with **P51 applications**—then assigning the portfolio is **sufficient**.

  Always ensure that the assigned ART or portfolio accurately reflects the **operational ownership** of the product.

Key Principles

- Use the **ART Fact Sheet** when agile teams are responsible for development and operations.
- Use the **Portfolio Fact Sheet** when responsibility is anchored in a business or IT portfolio.
- This ensures **clear accountability**, supports **agile governance**, and aligns with **LeanIX modeling standards**.

Please note

Only organizational fact sheets that are tagged with "**Synced**" or "**Manual**" may be used! The use of fact sheets with the tag "**Legacy**" is not allowed!

Modeling Version History with Successor and Predecessor Relations

In LeanIX, the **Successor** and **Predecessor** relations are used to model the **version history** of Fact Sheets over time.

These relations should be applied whenever a **new version** of an existing Fact Sheet is created to **replace** an older version.

Successor relations can also be used **while the previous version is still active** and in productive use.

Best Practice for Unused Relations

If no predecessor or successor exists for a given Fact Sheet, it is recommended to **explicitly set the relation field to**:

> **"Leave empty"**

This ensures clarity in the data model and avoids ambiguity in version tracking.

Key Principles

- Use **Successor/Predecessor** to document version transitions.
- Apply even if the older version is still operational.
- If not applicable, set the relation field to **"Leave empty"** instead of leaving it undefined.

Modeling Hierarchies with Parent/Child Relations in LeanIX

In LeanIX, **Parent/Child relations** are used to model **hierarchical dependencies** between Fact Sheets. These relations help structure complex systems, portfolios, or organizational units by defining **logical containment** or **ownership hierarchies**.

Usage Guidelines

- A **Parent Fact Sheet** represents a higher-level entity that logically contains or governs one or more **Child Fact Sheets**.
- A **Child Fact Sheet** is a subordinate entity that inherits context or structure from its parent.

This relation is commonly used in the following scenarios:

Use Case	Parent Type	Child Type
Application Suite	Application	Application
Platform Composition	Platform	IT Component
Organizational Hierarchy	Organization Unit	Sub-Unit
Portfolio Structure	Portfolio	Product / Application

Special Rule for IT Products

> **For the Fact Sheet type "IT Product", the Parent/Child relation must only be used after prior consultation with the responsible Portfolio Architect and the LeanIX team.**
> This ensures that hierarchical modeling aligns with enterprise architecture principles and avoids misrepresentation of product structures.

Best Practices

- Use Parent/Child relations to **group related Fact Sheets** under a common context.
- Ensure that the hierarchy reflects **actual ownership or architectural structure**.
- Avoid circular or ambiguous relationships.
- Document the rationale for the hierarchy in the **description field** of the Fact Sheet if needed.
- **If the Parent/Child relation is not applicable**, explicitly set the field to **"Leave empty"** to ensure clarity and data quality.

Benefits

- Improves **navigability** and **traceability** in LeanIX.
- Supports **impact analysis** and **portfolio planning**.
- Enables **structured reporting** and **governance alignment**.

Specific Modelling Rules and Best Practices for an Initiative

Purpose

An **Initiative** represents a **time-bound, goal-oriented effort** that implements a strategic or operational objective. It serves as the operational layer of enterprise transformation and enables traceability from planning to execution.

Link to Objectives

Each Initiative must be linked to a clearly defined **Objective**:

- The Objective provides **strategic context** and justification.
- Initiatives without a corresponding Objective are considered **invalid** from an architectural perspective.
- The relationship between Initiative and Objective ensures **alignment and traceability**.

System Assignment Principles

Systems (e.g. IT products) must be assigned **only at the initiative level**, not redundantly at the objective level:

- This avoids **data duplication** and reduces **maintenance complexity**.
- Assignments should be made at the **lowest meaningful level**, typically the IT product.

  Best Practice: Avoid assigning the same system to both the Initiative and the Objective.

Interface and Impact Modeling

When assigning systems to an Initiative:

- Focus on identifying **actual interfaces and points of impact**.
- In most cases, assigning **only the directly affected IT products** is sufficient.
- If IT Product fact sheets are properly maintained, **indirect impacts** (e.g. on business capabilities, IT components, or processes) can be **inferred** via the linked IT products.

Governance and Ownership

- There is **no central authority** for managing Initiatives.
- Responsibility for creation, maintenance, and usage lies with the **creator and user**.
- For guidance, consult the **Enterprise Architects of the respective portfolio** or the **Chief Architects**.

When using initiatives and objectives, it is important to note that LeanIX is not a project management tool!

Summary – Initiative

Section	Key Entity	Relationships / Rules
Purpose	Initiative	implements strategic or operational goals
Link to Objectives	Initiative → Objective	one-to-one (mandatory)
System Assignment	Initiative → IT Product	one-to-many (lowest level only); avoid redundancy with Objective
Impact Modeling	Initiative → [Business Capability, IT Component, Process]	inferred via linked IT Products
Governance	Initiative → Architect Roles	advisory only; no central control

Metamodel View

The diagram shows the possible relations between the entities that can be used to model an initiative in the context of the appropriate architecture level.

Overview

The diagram illustrates the relationships between various architectural entities within the TOGAF® framework. It is divided into three layers:

- **A. Architecture Vision**
- **B. Business Architecture**

- **C. Technical Architecture**

1. Top Layer – Architecture Vision (TOGAF® A)

- **Entities:**
  - `Objective` (purple box)
  - `Initiative` (green box)
- **Relationships:**
  - `Objective` → supports/affects → `Initiative`
  - Both `Objective` and `Initiative` → affect → downstream architecture components
  - `Objective` is linked to a `responsible` organizational unit

2. Middle Layer – Business Architecture (TOGAF® B)

- **Entities:**
  - `Organization`
  - `Business Capability`
  - `IT Product`
  - `Digital Solution`
  - `Process`
  - `Interface`
- **Relationships:**
  - Both `Objective` and `Initiative` → affect → all listed business architecture components

3. Bottom Layer – Technical Architecture (TOGAF® C)

- **Entities:**
  - `IT Component`
  - `Tech Capability`
  - `ADR` (Architecture Decision Record)
- **Relationships:**
  - `Initiative` → affects → these technical components
  - Additional arrows indicate interdependencies among technical elements

Additional Notes

- Each TOGAF® layer is labeled with a yellow circle containing the respective letter (A, B, C).
- Arrows represent directed relationships such as:
  - “affects”
  - “supports”
  - “is responsible for”
- Color coding:
  - Purple: Objectives
  - Green: Initiatives
  - Magenta: Architecture components
  - Yellow: TOGAF® section labels